PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Syllabic N

The /n/ can be pronounced as an entire syllable, deleting the vowel altogether. A syllabic /n/ can occur when the /n/ is in an unstressed syllable. Notice how the vowels before each /n/ in the words below are deleted altogether. This knowledge will help you avoid over-pronouncing vowels that get dropped in the connected speech of native English speakers.

Often	> “ahh fn”
Person	> “per sn”
human	> “hyoo mn”
common	> “cah mmn”
happen	> “haa ppn”
taken	> “tay kn”
suddenly	> “sudn lee”
garden	> “gar dn”
region	> “ree jn”
student	> “stoo dnt”
absence	> “ab snse”
listen	> “lih sn”
efficiency	> “uh fish n see”
written	> “wri tn”
medicine	> “meh duh sn”